

CON Ventures — Launch Checklist to First Dollar

Winners Circle WC LLC · Charlotte, NC · 20 construction ventures · Updated 2026-06-24

How to use this: The 6-step launch checklist is identical for every CON venture. Only **Step 2 (license)** changes by trade — that splits the 20 ventures into 3 tiers. **Start with Tier A** (no license, fastest dollar), **sub under GCs for Tier B**, and get a license or licensed partner for **Tier C**.

Verify current NC thresholds/rules before relying on them — boards update periodically.

The Universal 6-Step Checklist (every venture)

- ☐ **Step 0 — Insurance:** bind \$1M/\$2M General Liability (Next, Thimble, biBERK, Hiscox). Add Workers' Comp once you have W-2 employees; subs carry their own.
- ☐ **Step 1 — Entity ready:** operate under Winners Circle WC LLC; confirm NC business/privilege registration + EIN; open business bank account.
- ☐ **Step 2 — License (TRADE-SPECIFIC → see tier tables below):** obtain the NC license the trade requires, OR start by subcontracting under a licensed GC.
- ☐ **Step 3 — Offer + pricing:** define scope, line up crew/subs, set your markup rate before quoting.
- ☐ **Step 4 — Subcontract pre-quals:** register with NC GCs winning federal/commercial work (SYNCON, HICAPS, Group III, Riley, CMC) — then call estimating.
- ☐ **Step 5 — Federal track (parallel):** APEX Accelerator (free help) → Login.gov → UEI + SAM.gov registration (honest reps & certs) → SBA certs.
- ☐ **Step 6 — Contracts in hand:** Subcontractor Agreement, Client Service Agreement, Independent Contractor Agreement (see contracts section).

Tier A — No NC State License Needed (fastest to first dollar)

Start these THIS WEEK. Need only insurance + LLC + offer. (State trade license not required in NC; a GC license still applies only if a single project exceeds the GC threshold.)

Venture	Trade	License Step 2	Fastest path
CON-013	Painting	None	Direct-to-homeowner + sub to GCs
CON-014	Flooring	None	Direct + sub
CON-015	Landscaping	None	Direct-to-homeowner
CON-016	Demolition	None*	Sub to GCs (*permits per job)
CON-018	Carpentry	None	Sub to GCs
CON-019	Window Installation	None	Direct + sub
CON-020	Insulation	None	Sub to GCs
CON-005	Equipment Rental	None	Asset/rental — no trade license
CON-006	Project Management	None*	Service/consulting (*GC license if contracting the work)

Tier B — NC General Contractor License if Project ≥ ~\$40k

You can start NOW by subcontracting smaller scopes under a licensed GC (no license needed to sub). Get the NCLBGC license to prime larger jobs. Apply: nclbgc.org

Venture	Trade	License Step 2	Fastest path
CON-001	Ace / General Construction	GC if ≥\$40k	Sub now; license to prime
CON-002	Residential Construction	GC if ≥\$40k	Sub / small jobs now
CON-003	Commercial Construction	GC if ≥\$40k	Sub under GCs
CON-004	Industrial Construction	GC if ≥\$40k	Sub under GCs
CON-007	Green Building	GC if ≥\$40k	Sub + LEED niche
CON-008	Home Renovation	GC if ≥\$40k	Small renos now; license to scale
CON-009	Roofing	GC if ≥\$40k	Residential under threshold + sub to GCs
CON-017	Concrete	GC if ≥\$40k	Sub to GCs

Tier C — Dedicated NC Trade License Required (regardless of job size)

These need a state board license (exam + experience) OR a licensed qualifier/partner. Highest barrier, highest rate. Start as a helper/sub under a licensed contractor while you qualify.

Venture	Trade	License Step 2	Board / Path
CON-011	Electrical	Electrical license	NC Board of Examiners of Electrical Contractors
CON-010	Plumbing	Plumbing license	NC Board of Plumbing, Heating & Fire Sprinkler
CON-012	HVAC	Heating/Mech. license	NC Board of Plumbing, Heating & Fire Sprinkler

Recommended Launch Order

- ☐ **Week 1 (money):** Pick 1 Tier A venture you can personally deliver + 1 Tier B to sub (e.g., CON-009 Roofing). Insurance + 5 GC pre-quals + first calls.
- ☐ **Week 2-4:** SAM.gov registration (Step 5) in parallel. First sub task order landed.
- ☐ **Month 2-3:** NCLBGC license application for Tier B priming. Reinvest first revenue.
- ☐ **Month 3+:** Pursue Tier C via licensed partner or your own exam.

Contracts Each Venture Needs

Every CON venture runs on the same 3 core agreements. Draft each to attorney-review standard (clear parties, scope, payment, IP/ownership, confidentiality, warranties, indemnification, termination, dispute resolution, governing law = North Carolina):

- ☐ **Subcontractor Agreement** — between Winners Circle WC LLC and the crews/subs you hire (defines scope, pay, insurance requirements, liability).
- ☐ **Client / Master Service Agreement** — between you and the GC or homeowner client (scope, deliverables, payment schedule, change orders, warranty).
- ☐ **Independent Contractor Agreement** — for 1099 labor (status, payment, no-benefits, IP, confidentiality).

These are reusable across all 20 ventures — draft once, swap the scope/trade per venture.

Winners Circle WC LLC · winnerscirclewcllc@gmail.com · Generated for internal execution. Not legal advice — verify NC licensing thresholds (NCLBGC, trade boards) and have contracts reviewed by an attorney. Source data: [USASpending](#), NC licensing boards, SAM.gov.